

26/8/22

Advantages:

- i) Determining the total cost, variable cost & fixed cost at a given level of alternative.
- ii) Finding out BE output & sales
- iii) Understanding the cost, volume & profit relationship
- iv) Making inter-firm comparison
- v) Enforcing cost control. ✓

Limitations:

- i) difficult to segregate the cost into fixed & variable component as both of them varies to a certain extent after production reaches to a certain level.
- ii) The application of BE analysis to a multiproduct firm is very difficult. A lot of complicated complications are involved.
- iii) BEP has only limited importance. At best, it would induce management in cost reduction over times of dull business.
- iv) BEP provides neither a std. Performance nor a guide for executive decision.

* Estimation Techniques:

1. Algorithmic Cost modeling
 2. Expert judgement
 3. Estimation by analogy
 - ✓ 4. Parkinson's Law
- (5) pricing to win

✓ Algorithmic Cost modeling:

↳ based on historical cost information that relates some ϕ metric to the project cost incurred.

Parkinson's Law:

- work expands to fill the time available.
- Available resources determine the cost rather than by objective assessment.
- If the ϕ has to be delivered in 12 months & 5 people are available, the effort required is estimated to be 60 person months.

* COCOMO Model:

- Dr. Barry Boehm's.
- It is an algorithmic model developed based on project experience.
- It is heuristic in nature.

Advantages:

- i) Objective, repeatable
- ii) has modifiable & analyzable formulas.
- iii) Efficient & able to support sensitivity analysis
- iv) objectively calibrated to previous experience

Disadv.

- i) Unable to deal with exceptional conditions.
- ii) Poor sizing ϕ s & inaccurate cost driver rating will result in inaccurate estimation
- iii) Some experience & factors can not be easily quantified.

Assumptions of COCOMO

- i) System development should use waterfall process.
- ii) All ϕ development start from scratch.

iii) Development time doesn't increase linearly with product size for larger products.

iv) Development time is roughly the same for all the three categories of products.

$$Effort = a_1 * (KLOC)^{A_{PM}}$$

$$T_{dev} = b_1 * (Effort)^{B_{months}}$$

a) Simple/organic Model with project group:

- Relatively small group
- working to develop well understood applications.

b) Moderate/semit detached model

- Consists of mixture of experienced & inexperienced staff.

c) Embedded model emphasizes on the type & ergonomics:

- The s/w is strongly coupled to complex hardware or real time system.

Project	a_1	A	b_1	B
Simple/organic	2.4	1.05	2.5	0.38
Moderate	3.0	1.12	2.5	0.35
Embedded	3.6	1.2	2.5	0.32

Development Size Effort:

Organic: $Effort = 2.4(KLOC)^{1.05} PM$

Moderate: $Effort = 3.0(KLOC)^{1.12} PM$

Embedded: $Effort = 3.6(KLOC)^{1.20} PM$

Estimation of development time:

Organic: $T_{dev} = 2.5 (\text{Effort})^{0.38}$ months

Moderate: $T_{dev} = 2.5 (\text{Effort})^{0.35}$ months

Embedded: $T_{dev} = 2.5 (\text{Effort})^{0.32}$ months

$$\text{Productivity (P)} = \left[\frac{\text{KLOC}}{\text{Effort}} \right] \frac{\text{KLOC}}{\text{PM}}$$

1 Ex:

LOC = 62000, avg. salary of s/w engineer = 20K per man month.

a) effort = ?

b) T_{dev} = ?

c) cost required = ?

} organic project =